Home Appliances Return Policy

ShopSphere Retail - air purifiers, kitchen and cleaning appliances (including HomeHive)

Policy ID	POL-HOME-2024-05
Version	1.8
Effective date	2025-01-01
Applicable category	home_appliances
Return window (days)	15 (change of mind) / 30 (defect or damage)
Policy owner	Returns Policy Office, Mumbai
Review cycle	Annual, or earlier on regulatory change

1. Purpose and scope

This policy covers returns of home appliances, including HomeHive air purifiers. Large or installed appliances require scheduled pickup and, where applicable, de-installation by an authorised partner.

2. Return windows

Situation	Window (days from delivery)	Conditions
Change of mind	15	Unused, not installed, original carton and all filters/accessories
Defect or not functioning	30	Fault verified by inspection; afterwards the 24-month warranty applies where offered
Damaged on arrival	Report within 48 hours	See POL-DMG-2024-04
Safety concern (overheating, burning smell, sparking)	Any time	Customer must stop using the product; pickup is prioritised

3. Installation

- Appliances installed by a ShopSphere authorised partner keep their return eligibility; the installation date is recorded on the service ticket.
- Damage caused by third-party installation is not covered by this policy.
- Air purifiers do not require installation; filters must be returned with the unit.

4. Pickup

- Pickup is scheduled within 3 business days of an approved return request.
- The customer should repack the unit in the original carton where available; the pickup agent records outer packaging condition.
- Units reported as unsafe are collected in a fire-safe bag and labelled for quarantine on arrival.

5. Safety

Any appliance that an inspector classifies as unsafe (for example thermal damage, exposed live parts, insulation failure) must be quarantined and may not be resold, refurbished for resale or returned to stock. Disposition is limited to recycle or dispose under RFB-SAF-2025-02. An investigation case of type safety_concern is opened and the supplier is notified.

6. Required documentation

- Order ID and return ID.
- Photographs of the unit and rating label.

- Description of fault; error codes where shown.
- Installation ticket (installed appliances only).

7. Refund approval thresholds

Refund amount	Approver	Notes
Up to INR 10,000	Returns analyst	Every refund raised by the returns investigation assistant needs a human approval before execution.
INR 10,000.01 to INR 50,000	Returns supervisor	Analyst recommendation plus supervisor sign-off.
Above INR 50,000	Returns supervisor and Finance controller	Dual approval; inspection report must be attached.
Any amount with an open investigation case	Returns supervisor	Refund is held until the case is resolved.

8. Refund rules

- A return may have at most one completed refund. Before any refund is requested, the refunds ledger must be checked; if a completed refund already exists for the return_id, no further refund may be requested or executed.
- Refunds are issued to the original payment method within 5-7 business days of approval. Store credit is issued only when the customer selects it.
- Refund amounts may not exceed the unit price paid on the order line (order_items.unit_price), excluding any promotional cashback already reversed.